

Q I have a Pentium 4 1.8 GHz Processor and an 845 GLVA Intel original motherboard, which has inbuilt audio and video. I want to know if I can install external audio or video cards on this motherboard, and whether I need to change any BIOS settings. Is there any way of knowing the speed of the DDR-RAM of my system?

Tathagata Ray

A Sorry, your motherboard does not have an AGP slot, so you're stuck with the integrated graphics chipset. You can install a PCI video card such as a TV-tuner card for better graphics. For an enhanced sound solution, use an add-on PCI sound card. All you need to do is disable the onboard sound card from the BIOS. Windows does not provide a reliable utility to check the RAM clock speed, but you can see it when you start your system. At the first screen, where you see the RAM count taking place, you can also see the RAM clock speed. Another option is to use a freeware utility called WCPUID (www.hoda.com), to see the RAM clock speed.

Q I recently upgraded my home PC, following your advice for the latest motherboard, processor and graphics. My configuration is: an MSI KT4 Ultra SR, 333 FSB motherboard with VIA Technologies Inc VT8377 chipset, Apollo KT400 CPU to PCI Bridge, A6590VMS V1.1 091102 AMIBIOS Version 3.31a, an AMD Athlon XP 2600+, 2.083 GHz, 333 MHz FSB processor, Kingston DDR 512 MB, 333 MHz RAM, Seagate Barracuda ST380011A, 80 GB, 7,200-rpm hard drive, SMEDIA nVIDIA GeForce MX 440 SE, 64 MB DDR w/TV, AGP 4X graphics card-all running Windows 98 (C Drive) and Windows XP (D Drive). I also have an ibox cabinet, a 300 W power supply and an APC Back-UPS UPS.

The problem is that my AMD Athlon XP 2600+ runs only at 1.90 GHz, when it should run at 2.083 GHz. The CPU performance is also at par with an Athlon XP processor running at 1.90 GHz, which I tested with the SiSoft Sandra 2003 Standard software I got from the Digit June 2003 CD. In the BIOS setup (AMIBIOS New